IDEATION PHASE

Define the Problem Statements

Streamlining IT procurement through standard laptop order automation

Session detail	Working value
Date	1 October 2026
Team / facilitator	SWTID-2026-2070
Project	Automating standard laptop orders with Flow Designer
Statement status	Working hypotheses; validate before design

Purpose

Describe the people affected and the problem they experience before deciding how the workflow should solve it. This worksheet focuses on routine, policy-compliant laptop orders. The Flow Designer automation is the project direction; it should not be treated as proof of the problem or inserted as the answer in the customer statement.

Problem statement structure

Part	Prompt for the session
I am (customer)	Who experiences the problem? Name a role and relevant context, not a broad group.
I'm trying to	What outcome are they trying to achieve? Describe the job, not a feature request.
But	What obstacle, delay, uncertainty, or rework gets in the way?
Because	What evidence-backed cause or process condition creates the obstacle? Separate root cause from a symptom.
Which makes me feel	What impact does the person report? Capture their words where possible; do not assume emotions.

Project scope to keep in view

Consider in scope	Flag as an exception or separate decision
Approved standard laptop options; requester and cost details; eligibility and approvals; routine order status; receipt, asset assignment, and employee handoff.	Non-standard hardware; urgent or replacement exceptions; unusual locations; policy or budget exceptions; unavailable stock; unclear system ownership.

Facilitator checks

- State the problem from the affected person's point of view. Keep the "because" clause focused on causes supported by evidence.

- Keep solution ideas such as auto-approval, integrations, or Flow Designer in a separate solution discussion.

- If a claim is not yet supported, label it as a hypothesis and name how the team will validate it.

Working hypotheses for this project

Use these as discussion starters, not confirmed findings. Revise the wording after reviewing request examples, interviews, process steps, and service or procurement data.

Hypothesis 1 Employee or manager requesting a laptop

Statement part	Working draft
I am	An employee or manager requesting a standard laptop for a role, start date, or planned refresh.
I'm trying to	Get an appropriate, approved device requested and delivered when it is needed.
But	I may not know which option I qualify for, what information is required, who must act next, or when the laptop will arrive.
Because	The request, eligibility checks, approvals, purchasing, and delivery updates may be handled in separate steps with unclear status or ownership.
Which makes me feel	I may feel uncertain or frustrated while waiting or following up. Confirm the actual impact with requesters.

Combined draft: I am an employee or manager requesting a standard laptop. I am trying to get an appropriate, approved device delivered when it is needed, but I may be unsure which option I qualify for, what information is required, who acts next, or when it will arrive. Because the request, checks, approvals, purchasing, and updates may span separate steps, I may feel uncertain while waiting or following up.

Hypothesis 2 IT or procurement coordinator

Statement part	Working draft
I am	An IT or procurement coordinator supporting standard laptop orders.
I'm trying to	Move eligible requests through review and fulfillment while maintaining purchasing and asset controls.
But	I may need to correct incomplete requests, check details across teams, and chase the current owner or status.
Because	Request data, policy decisions, purchase progress, inventory, and asset handoff may sit across different process steps or systems.
Which makes me feel	The work may be hard to predict and rework hard to prevent. Validate the impact with coordinators.

Combined draft: I am an IT or procurement coordinator supporting standard laptop orders. I am trying to move eligible requests through review and fulfillment while maintaining controls, but I may need to correct incomplete requests and chase details, owners, or status across teams. Because request data, policy decisions, purchasing, inventory, and asset handoff may span different steps or systems, the work may be difficult to predict and rework may be difficult to prevent.

Evidence to gather before adopting either statement

- Examples of recent standard requests, including missing information, returns, approval waits, and exception reasons.

- Requester and coordinator interviews: ask what happened, where they waited or repeated work, and what impact they experienced.

- Current process map and available measures, such as elapsed time by stage, rework, incomplete submissions, follow-ups, and exception volume.

Problem statement worksheet

Complete one worksheet per affected role or distinct problem. Use concrete examples and mark unsupported details for validation.

Session detail	Fill in
Customer / role	[Who experiences the problem?]
Context	[When or under what circumstances does it occur?]
Date / contributors	[Date, team, and people consulted]
Evidence reviewed	[Requests, interviews, process map, measures, or other source]

Statement part	Prompt	Draft
I am (customer)	Who is affected, and what relevant context identifies them?	[Role and context]
I'm trying to	What outcome are they trying to achieve?	[Desired outcome]
But	What barrier or friction gets in the way?	[Observed barrier]
Because	What evidence-backed condition causes the barrier?	[Root cause or process condition]
Which makes me feel	What impact does the person describe?	[Reported impact or feeling]

Combined problem statement

Draft
I am [customer and context]. I am trying to [desired outcome], but [observed barrier], because [evidence-backed cause], which makes me feel [reported impact].

Validation and decision

Check	Notes
Evidence that supports this statement	[Examples, sources, or measures]
Evidence that challenges or narrows it	[Counterexamples, exceptions, or unknowns]
Who needs to validate the wording?	[Requester, manager, IT, procurement, finance, etc.]
Problem statement accepted?	[Yes / revise / more evidence needed; decision date]

How might we

Once the problem is validated, reframe it as an opportunity without naming a solution: “How might we [help this customer achieve the outcome] despite [validated barrier]?”